

Dizziness in Pregnancy

Patient Education Pamphlet

Is Dizziness Common in Pregnancy?

Yes. Many women experience dizziness at some point during pregnancy. It can feel like:

- Lightheadedness
- Feeling faint
- Room spinning (vertigo)
- Unsteadiness

Most causes are normal and related to pregnancy changes, but occasionally dizziness can signal a more serious condition.

Common Causes

- 1. Low Blood Pressure** — Hormonal changes cause blood vessels to relax, which may lower blood pressure—especially in the first and second trimesters.
- 2. Lying Flat on Your Back** — In later pregnancy, the uterus can press on major blood vessels when you lie on your back, reducing blood flow and causing dizziness (supine hypotensive syndrome).
- 3. Low Blood Sugar** — Skipping meals or long gaps between eating can cause lightheadedness.
- 4. Dehydration** — Not drinking enough fluids can worsen dizziness.
- 5. Anemia** — Low iron levels are common in pregnancy and may cause fatigue and dizziness.
- 6. Sudden Position Changes** — Standing up too quickly can cause a brief drop in blood pressure (orthostatic hypotension).

What You Can Do

Helpful Tips

- Change positions slowly, especially when getting out of bed.
- Avoid lying flat on your back after the first trimester; lie on your side instead (preferably left side).
- Eat small, frequent meals to keep blood sugar stable.
- Stay well hydrated (aim for 8–12 cups of fluids daily unless otherwise instructed).
- Take prescribed prenatal vitamins and iron as directed.
- Sit or lie down immediately if you feel faint.

If you feel dizzy while standing, sit down and place your head between your knees or lie on your side until it passes.

When to Call the Office Immediately

Seek prompt evaluation if dizziness occurs with any of the following:

Warning Signs

- Fainting or loss of consciousness
- Chest pain or shortness of breath
- Severe headache
- Vision changes
- Heavy vaginal bleeding
- Severe abdominal or pelvic pain
- Shoulder pain
- Persistent vomiting
- Palpitations or irregular heartbeat
- Sudden swelling of face or hands

These symptoms may require urgent evaluation.

Important Safety Tips

- Avoid driving if you are feeling dizzy.
- Use handrails when walking on stairs.
- Avoid standing for long periods without moving.
- Sit down if you feel symptoms coming on.

Reassurance

In most cases, pregnancy-related dizziness is temporary and improves with simple measures. However, it is always appropriate to mention symptoms at your prenatal visits so we can ensure there is no underlying concern.

If you have questions or your symptoms worsen, please contact our office.